

D291

Learning Experience Design Foundations I

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A design team at a company with a well-known brand is updating a compliance course. One member suggests interviewing new hires about where they get stuck and watching them use the course. The course has 14 modules. What does this suggestion add?

- A. A purely content-first design.
- B. Better visual branding.
- C. A user experience lens: designing from real learners' needs and behavior.
- D. A shorter course, since fewer modules is always better.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A nonprofit with a large volunteer base wants online training for new volunteers. The director, who loves podcasts, already wants a podcast series. No volunteers have been asked about their challenges yet. What should the designer do first?

- A. Interview and observe volunteers, then write a learner-centered problem statement.
- B. Write the final evaluation survey.
- C. Build a prototype and test it.
- D. Start producing the podcast series.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is a well-formed, learner-centered problem statement from the define phase?

- A. "New volunteers need a quick way to find answers during their first shift because they feel embarrassed asking staff."
- B. "We need a podcast series for volunteers."
- C. "Volunteers must understand everything about the organization."
- D. "The course will have 10 modules."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A team at a fast-growing startup must build a sales course in six weeks. Needs are unclear and stakeholders want to see something early. The team sits in an open-plan office. Which model fits better?

- A. ADDIE, completing full analysis before any design.
- B. A 12-week ADDIE plan.
- C. No model, since startups move too fast.
- D. SAM, using quick prototypes and review cycles.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project has stable, well-defined content, strict regulatory sign-off at each phase, and a fixed launch date. Which model's structure matches these conditions?

- A. Design thinking's ideate phase only.
- B. SAM, because iteration is always better.
- C. ADDIE, with distinct phases and sign-offs.
- D. Agile software sprints with no design phase.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A designer creating onboarding for warehouse staff writes a persona named “Maria” based on his guess that staff are young and tech-savvy. He has a strong portfolio of past projects. What is the main problem?

- A. The persona needs a different name.
- B. The persona is not based on research with actual warehouse staff.
- C. Personas are never useful.
- D. His portfolio shows he knows the learners.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A hospital system with a new logo asks for a course on entering patient meal orders. Staff did it correctly for years, but errors rose after a software update moved the order button to a hidden menu. What is the best recommendation?

- A. Fix the interface or add a job aid; a full course is not the main answer.
- B. Rebrand the course with the new logo.
- C. Build a full course on meal orders.
- D. Require staff to retake all onboarding.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which situation most clearly calls for a learning solution?

- A. Every performance problem calls for training.
- B. Workers cannot finish orders because the scanner is broken.
- C. Experienced staff skip a step because they are rewarded for speed.
- D. Newly hired analysts have never used the company's forecasting method.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A designer at a busy regional bank drafts: "Tellers will understand the new cash-handling policy." The policy is 18 pages long. What is the biggest weakness?

- A. The audience is missing.
- B. The verb is not observable, and there are no conditions or criteria.
- C. The policy is too long.
- D. It should say "know" instead of "understand."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

In a course designed at a university with a large online program, learners work in teams on a messy, real client case, discussing and building their own solutions. Which theory best matches this strategy?

- A. Behaviorism.
- B. Online learning theory, since it is online.
- C. Constructivism.
- D. Cognitivism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A designer following cognitivism is planning a complex topic. Which strategy fits that theory?

- A.** Present all content at once to save time.
- B.** Chunk content and start with an advance organizer that shows how parts connect.
- C.** Open-ended team projects with little structure.
- D.** Drill-and-practice with points for each correct answer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

Adult learners at a large retail chain rate a new safety course as pointless. Designers find the examples come from factory settings, not stores. The course uses bright animations. Which ARCS element is weakest?

- A.** Attention.
- B.** Satisfaction.
- C.** Confidence.
- D.** Relevance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A design team ~~at a company with a well-known brand~~ is updating a compliance course. One member suggests interviewing new hires about where they get stuck and watching them use the course. ~~The course has 14 modules.~~ What does this suggestion add?

Target word: what LxD adds **Decides:** Research with real users about their experience.

A	Inverted operation	The suggestion is learner-first, not content-first.
B	Camouflage	The brand detail does not decide the concept; LxD is more than looks.
C	Correct	LxD adds UX methods to instructional design.
D	Absolute language	Length is not what the suggestion addresses.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A nonprofit ~~with a large volunteer base~~ wants online training for new volunteers. The director, ~~who loves podcasts,~~ already wants a podcast series. No volunteers have been asked about their challenges yet. What should the designer do first?

Target word: first design-thinking step **Decides:** No learner insight yet.

A	Correct	Empathize and define come before solutions.
B	Adjacent category	Evaluation comes later.
C	Dropped element	Skips empathize and define.
D	Camouflage	Follows the director's preference, not learner insight.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

Which is a well-formed, learner-centered problem statement from the define phase?

Target word: pick the define-phase output **Decides:** States a learner, need, and insight without a solution.

A	Correct	Learner, need, and insight, with no solution locked in.
B	Inverted operation	States a solution, not a problem.
C	Absolute language	Too broad and not based on insight.
D	Adjacent category	A design spec, not a problem.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A team at a fast-growing startup must build a sales course in six weeks. Needs are unclear and stakeholders want to see something early. ~~The team sits in an open-plan office.~~ Which model fits better?

Target word: choose a model **Decides:** Unclear needs, early feedback, short timeline.

A	Inverted operation	Linear phases delay feedback.
B	Wrong stem number	Ignores the six-week limit.
C	Absolute language	A light, iterative model still guides work.
D	Correct	Iterative cycles handle unclear needs and early feedback.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A project has stable, well-defined content, strict regulatory sign-off at each phase, and a fixed launch date. Which model's structure matches these conditions?

Target word: choose model — reversed conditions **Decides:** Stable content and phase sign-offs.

A	Dropped element	Leaves out the full process.
B	Absolute language	Model fit depends on conditions.
C	Correct	Linear phases fit stable content and formal approvals.
D	Adjacent category	A development method, not an ID model that fits sign-offs.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A designer creating onboarding for warehouse staff writes a persona named “Maria” based on his guess that staff are young and tech-savvy. ~~He has a strong portfolio of past projects.~~ What is the main problem?

Target word: persona quality **Decides:** Persona built from guesses, not data.

A	Adjacent category	The name does not matter.
B	Correct	Personas must reflect real learner data.
C	Absolute language	Research-based personas guide design.
D	Camouflage	Past work is not learner data.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A hospital system ~~with a new logo~~ asks for a course on entering patient meal orders. Staff did it correctly for years, but errors rose after a software update moved the order button to a hidden menu. What is the best recommendation?

Target word: learning problem or not **Decides:** Staff had the skill; the tool changed.

A	Correct	The gap is caused by the tool, not a skill gap.
B	Camouflage	Branding does not fix errors.
C	Inverted operation	Treats a tool problem as a learning problem.
D	Adjacent category	Retraining known skills does not fix the tool.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Which situation most clearly calls for a learning solution?

Target word: spot the true skill gap **Decides:** People lack a skill they never had.

A	Absolute language	Many gaps have non-training causes.
B	Adjacent category	A tool problem.
C	Confusion set	An incentive problem.
D	Correct	A true knowledge and skill gap.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A designer at a busy regional bank drafts: "Tellers will understand the new cash-handling policy." The policy is 18 pages long. What is the biggest weakness?

Target word: fix the objective **Decides:** "Understand" is not observable.

A	Dropped element	"Tellers" is the audience.
B	Correct	Needs an observable behavior, conditions, and degree.
C	Camouflage	Policy length is not part of the objective.
D	Confusion set	Also unobservable.

10. Answer C Concept 7

In a course designed at a university with a large online program, learners work in teams on a messy, real client case, discussing and building their own solutions. Which theory best matches this strategy?

Target word: strategy to theory **Decides:** Learners build meaning through authentic problems.

A	Confusion set	Focuses on practice and reinforcement.
B	Camouflage	Delivery mode is not a learning theory.
C	Correct	Learners construct knowledge through authentic tasks and discussion.
D	Confusion set	Focuses on organizing information for memory.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

A designer following cognitivism is planning a complex topic. Which strategy fits that theory?

Target word: theory to strategy — reversed direction **Decides:** Cognitivism organizes information for memory.

A	Inverted operation	Overloads memory.
B	Correct	Organizes information to fit working memory.
C	Adjacent category	Constructivist.
D	Confusion set	A behaviorist strategy.

12. Answer D Concept 8

Adult learners at a large retail chain rate a new safety course as pointless. Designers find the examples come from factory settings, not stores. The course uses bright animations. Which ARCS element is weakest?

Target word: classify the motivation problem **Decides:** Examples do not connect to learners' jobs.

A	Camouflage	Animations already grab attention; that is not the gap.
B	Adjacent category	About rewards or payoff after learning.
C	Confusion set	About expecting success, not relevance.
D	Correct	Content does not link to learners' work.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	What LxD adds to instructional design	Learning experience design blends instructional design (sound learning goals and strategies) with user experience design (research with real users, usability, and emotional experience) to create human-centered learning.	Thinking LxD is just making courses look attractive.	A design choice justified by learners' real needs and experience vs. by content alone.
2	Empathize, then define	The first design-thinking phases gather insight directly from learners (interviews, observation) and then turn it into a learner-centered problem statement before any solution is chosen.	Jumping to a solution, such as building a video series, before understanding learners.	A team that has an idea but has not yet talked to learners.
3	ADDIE vs. SAM	ADDIE moves through analysis, design, development, implementation, and evaluation in largely linear phases; SAM uses short, repeated design-prototype-review cycles.	Calling ADDIE iterative by default, or thinking SAM skips analysis.	A project with fixed phases vs. rapid repeated prototypes.
4	Learner analysis and personas	Personas are research-based profiles of real learner groups (prior knowledge, context, goals, barriers) used to guide design decisions.	Building personas from assumptions or designing for an average learner no one resembles.	A persona built without learner data, or a design choice made without learner context.
5	Is it a learning problem?	A performance gap is a learning problem only if people lack knowledge or skill; gaps caused by tools, incentives, or processes need non-training fixes.	Assuming every performance problem needs a course.	People who could do the task before, or who lack tools or time, and a request for training.
6	Measurable objectives (ABCD)	A strong objective names the Audience, an observable Behavior, the Conditions, and the Degree or criterion of success.	Using unobservable verbs like understand, know, or appreciate.	A draft objective and a question about what is missing or weak.
7	Learning theories to strategies	Behaviorism favors practice with reinforcement; cognitivism favors organizing information to fit memory (chunking, advance organizers); constructivism favors learners building meaning through authentic problems and discussion.	Mixing up which strategies come from which theory.	A strategy description and a question about its theory.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	ARCS model of motivation	Design for Attention (curiosity), Relevance (links to learner goals), Confidence (clear expectations and reachable success), and Satisfaction (meaningful rewards or use).	Thinking motivation is only about grabbing attention with flashy media.	A motivation problem and a design fix to classify.

Course scope (public description): Learning Experience Design Foundations I provides an introduction to the field of learning experience design (LxD) and the role of the learning experience designer, which combines best practices from the fields of instructional design and user experience design, with the goal of creating human centered, goal-oriented learning experiences. This first of two foundational courses introduces Design Thinking and instructional design models, processes, and approaches. This course demonstrates how learning theories and instructional frameworks can be applied to facilitate deep learning, motivation, and engagement. This course also teaches the process for analyzing learners and their needs, as well as defining the instructional problem and goals. There are no prerequisites for this learning experience design course.